The Killing of *John Spencer Horner*

Floyd Township, Johnson County, Arkansas — August 2, 1864

Research: Daniel Lingar Dossier v. 16.0 March 2026 Clarksville, AR

ORIGINS THE ATTACK THE CHILDREN SEVEN DEATHS MAP PEOPLE
THE SHERIFF RECKONING SUSPECT THE LINE YALE CEMETERY
OPEN QUESTIONS SOURCES FULL DOSSIER

§ 00

Origins — The Family Before Arkansas

The man who died in the potato patch on August 2, 1864 was not the beginning of the story. He was part of a generations-long American migration that began on the Virginia frontier, moved through the Piedmont of North Carolina, crossed into the Tennessee wilderness, and finally came to rest in the Ozark hills of Johnson County, Arkansas.

The chain is documented. It runs from a 1752 land grant surveyed by George Washington to a murder in a potato patch.

4TH GREAT-GRANDFATHER · B. ~1726

George Horner Sr.

~1726 – ~1794 · Frederick County, VA → Orange County, North Carolina

The earliest confirmed ancestor of this line. Received 400 acres in Frederick County, Virginia in 1752, surveyed by George Washington. Later settled among the Scots-Irish frontier settlements of Orange County, NC. Appointed road overseer for the Eno River trading path, 1759. Died in North Carolina ~1794.

3RD GREAT-GRANDFATHER · B. OCT 30, 1746, YORK COUNTY, PENNSYLVANIA

William Horner Sr.

1746 – Oct 12, 1824 · York Co., PA → Randolph Co., NC → Jefferson Co., Tennessee

American Revolutionary War patriot. DAR #462142. Supplied beef and goods to the Continental Army. Family oral history states he hauled a four-horse wagon load of beef to General Washington at Valley Forge, winter 1777–1778. Deacon of Bent Creek Primitive Baptist Church. Buried Bent Creek Cemetery, Whitesburg, Tennessee.

2ND GREAT-GRANDFATHER · B. 1771, ORANGE COUNTY, NORTH CAROLINA

George Horner

1771 – Apr 15, 1822 · Orange Co., NC → Beardstown, Perry County, Tennessee

Son of William. Married Jemima Russell, 1795, Hickman County, Tennessee. Father of Spencer Horner. Died Perry County, Tennessee, April 1822.

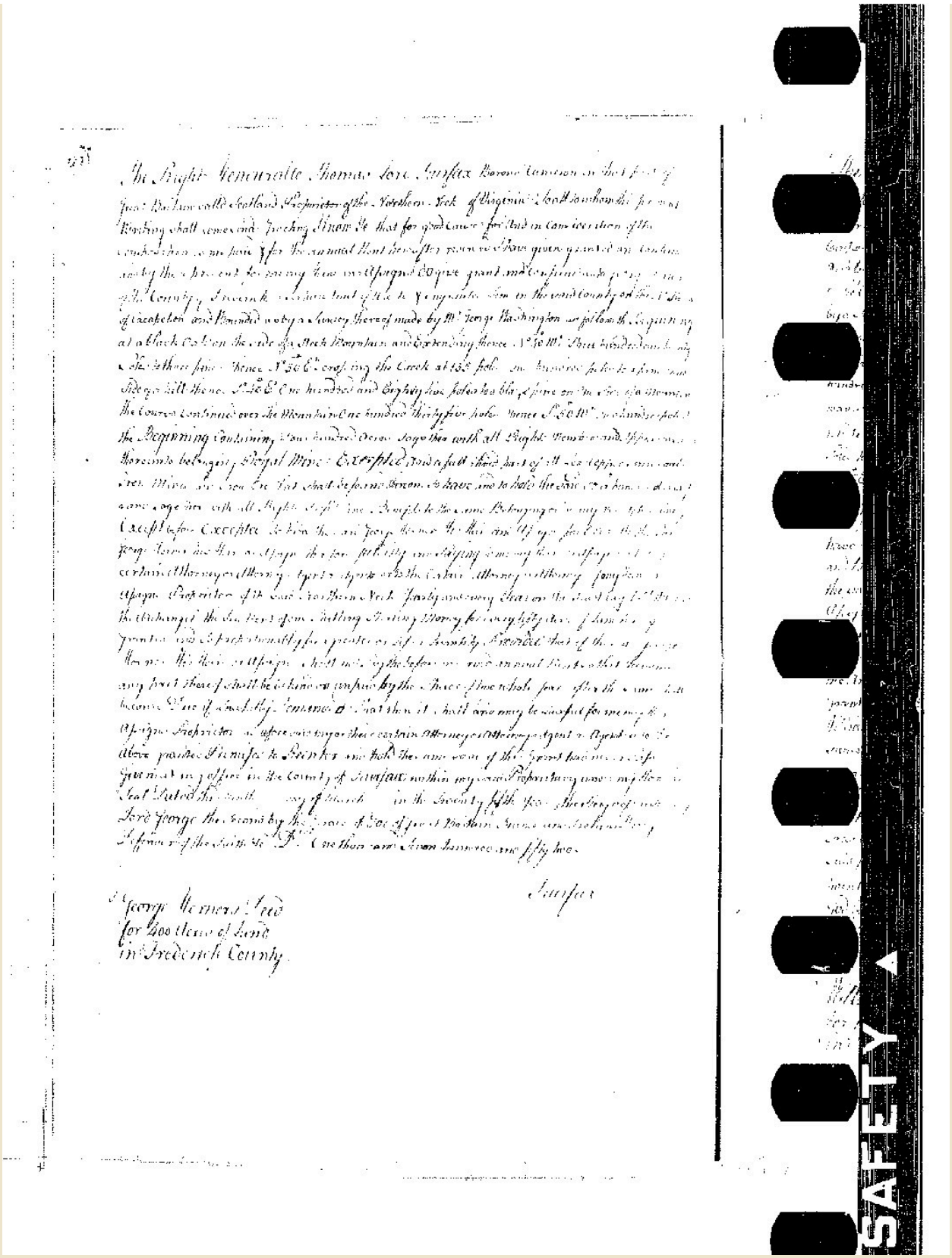
GREAT-GRANDFATHER · B. ~1808, DICKSON, TENNESSEE · MURDERED AUGUST 2, 1864

John Spencer Horner

~1808 – August 2, 1864 · Tennessee → Floyd Township, Johnson County, Arkansas

Union man in a Confederate county. Married Permelia Turner (b. Nov 11, 1810, Maury County, TN; d. Aug 9, 1892). Father of eleven children. Shot in his potato patch by approximately twenty men he recognized as neighbors. The subject of this archive.

The Washington Connection, 1752. George Horner Sr. owned 400 acres in Frederick County, Virginia on the North River of Cacapehon — surveyed by the young George Washington on March 9, 1752, and granted by Thomas Lord Fairfax. The same day, Washington surveyed an adjacent 292 acres belonging to a William Horner, likely a relative. This document survives.



Northern Neck Proprietary Grant · George Horner · 400 acres · Frederick County, Virginia · March 9, 1752 · Surveyed by George Washington · Granted by Thomas Lord Fairfax

The family's path from that Virginia frontier to the Arkansas hills follows the great Scots-Irish migration routes exactly — down the Great Wagon Trail through the Shenandoah Valley, into the Piedmont of North Carolina, then west into Tennessee, then south and west into Arkansas.

The Choctaw Scrip Patent, 1857

The land on which Spencer Horner was murdered seven years later was acquired under Choctaw scrip authority. On April 1, 1857, the General Land Office issued Patent No. 19B for 160 acres in Township 12 North, Range 24 West, at the Fayetteville Land Office. The patent text identifies Spencer Horner as assignee of Co-cha-tubbee, described in the instrument as a representative of Canne Chubbee, deceased.

This resolves the previously unexplained "Co-cha-tubbee" notation on the patent. The instrument is a Choctaw scrip certificate — one of the land warrants issued under the Treaty of Dancing Rabbit Creek (1830) and subsequent Choctaw Scrip Acts, which granted individual allotments to Choctaw Nation members who elected to remain in Mississippi. Many of these certificates were later assigned, sold, or transferred to non-Native settlers through a secondary market that the federal government recognized at its land offices. Canne Chubbee appears to be the original certificate holder; Co-cha-tubbee appears in a representative capacity — likely an heir, administrator, or authorized agent acting on behalf of the deceased allottee.

The Choctaw scrip chain of title supports a specific legal mechanism for Spencer's land acquisition. It does not, by itself, prove Native ancestry in the Horner line. The patent is a conveyance document — it records a transaction between a scrip holder's representative and an assignee, not a kinship relationship. Without additional evidence linking the Horner family to Choctaw enrollment records, the document establishes only that Spencer obtained his Floyd Township acreage through the Choctaw scrip system rather than by direct cash entry or preemption.

> **The Choctaw Scrip Connection.** BLM GLO accession AR2690__.426 (Document 19B, Class STA). The patent names Spencer Horner as assignee of Co-cha-tubbee, representative of Canne Chubbee, deceased. The underlying certificate traces to the Choctaw allotment system

created by the Treaty of Dancing Rabbit Creek (1830). Related federal record groups: NARA RG 49 (General Land Office — Choctaw Scrip Acts) and RG 75 (Bureau of Indian Affairs — Dancing Rabbit Creek claims).

§ 01

The Attack

On the morning of August 2, 1864 — a date fixed by William Riley Horner's tombstone, the 1942 family transcript, and his Union muster roll — one of Spencer's sons, the one they called Louis, took his horse up the mountain to get it shod, five miles from the house. Before he left, he told his father and his brother William: *whatever you do, don't go up to the house in the daytime. Stay back in the timber. Keep watch.*

But the women were killing a chicken for dinner, and the house was where the food was. So Spencer and William went up anyway.

The children had been posted as lookouts — a common precaution in those years, when bushwhackers moved through the hills like weather. When the boys saw men coming off the mountain, they ran inside hollering: *"Here they come, Grandpap!"*

Spencer walked out into the potato patch to meet them. There were about twenty riders, and according to the family account he recognized them — they were neighbors, men he knew by name. He raised his hands to surrender, but they shot him where he stood. The family account says he died at or near the homestead.

William Riley Horner ran for the timber, but they caught him in the potato field. They beat him with pistols and crushed his genitals, leaving him for dead. The women found him still breathing and carried him to a cave on the mountainside. He survived there for eight days, nursed by Mary Ann, before dying of head wounds on August 10, 1864.

The bushwhackers did not leave immediately. They ransacked the homestead — pulling down buildings, knocking fences flat, digging where they thought money might be buried. Spencer had gold and silver hidden somewhere on the farm. They never found it.

Full view of the stone at Moore Cemetery

Detail showing "WM. R. HORNER"

> *"Wm. R. Homer Born Aug. 1, 1834 Killed Aug. 10, 1864 by parties known to his family."*
>
> *His toil is o'er his work is done,*
> *And he is fully blest,*
> *He fought the fight the victory won,*
> *And entered into rest.*
>
> — Tombstone inscription, Moore Cemetery, Johnson County, Arkansas

The surname is cut as “Homer” — the misspelling preserved exactly as the stone carver rendered it. But the accusation was deliberate: *by parties known to his family*. A public record in stone, because the law would do nothing.

§ 02

The Children Who Watched

In the house that day were Spencer's orphaned grandsons: **John Samuel Acord**, age 7, and **Christopher Columbus Acord**, age 3. Their mother Elizabeth Horner Acord had died March 1, 1864, of pneumonia — she'd spent her days chopping wood in the cold rain to keep the fire going while her husband was away, and it killed her at twenty-eight. She had been born July 10, 1835, in Perry County, Tennessee — the same county where her grandfather George Horner had died in 1822. Their father Francis made it home to learn his wife was dead, then went back to his unit and died at Lewisburg Ridge on July 28, 1864, from fever. Five days before Spencer was murdered.

Spencer had taken the boys in after their mother's death in March. They had been at the farm for roughly five months when the riders came.

> **Connection to the researcher:** John Samuel Acord (born December 1, 1856; died March 20, 1928, Friley, Johnson County, Arkansas) is the 2nd great-grandfather of Daniel Lingar, who compiled this archive. This record exists because a seven-year-old boy survived what happened in that potato patch and lived to old age in the same county where it happened.

Spencer Horner was a tall man of fifty-six — a Union man in a predominantly Confederate county. He had two hundred acres at least. He had gold and silver hidden somewhere on the property. He had children scattered across Arkansas and Missouri, and he had these two boys, the youngest of the lot.

§ 03

The Seven Deaths of 1864

The killing of Spencer Horner was not an isolated act. It was the culmination of a year-long campaign of violence against Union-aligned families in Floyd Township. The deaths began in March and did not stop until August.

DATE	INDIVIDUAL	CAUSE	LOCATION
March 1, 1864	Elizabeth Horner Acord, age 28	Pneumonia — chopping wood in cold rain	Floyd Township
March 18, 1864	William Gordon Acord	**Murdered — ambushed in his own yard, betrayed by a neighbor**	Little Mulberry Creek
July 28, 1864	Francis Marion Acord	Fever — died July 28 per military record	Lewisburg Ridge
July 31, 1864	Andrew Jackson Horner	Measles	Lewisburg Ridge
August 2, 1864	John Spencer Horner, age 56	**Murdered — shot in the potato patch**	Floyd Township homestead
August 10, 1864	William Riley Horner, age 30	**Died of wounds — cave on mountainside**	Floyd Township
August 12, 1864	Pleasant Horner	Disease — died Aug 12 per military record	Morrilton area

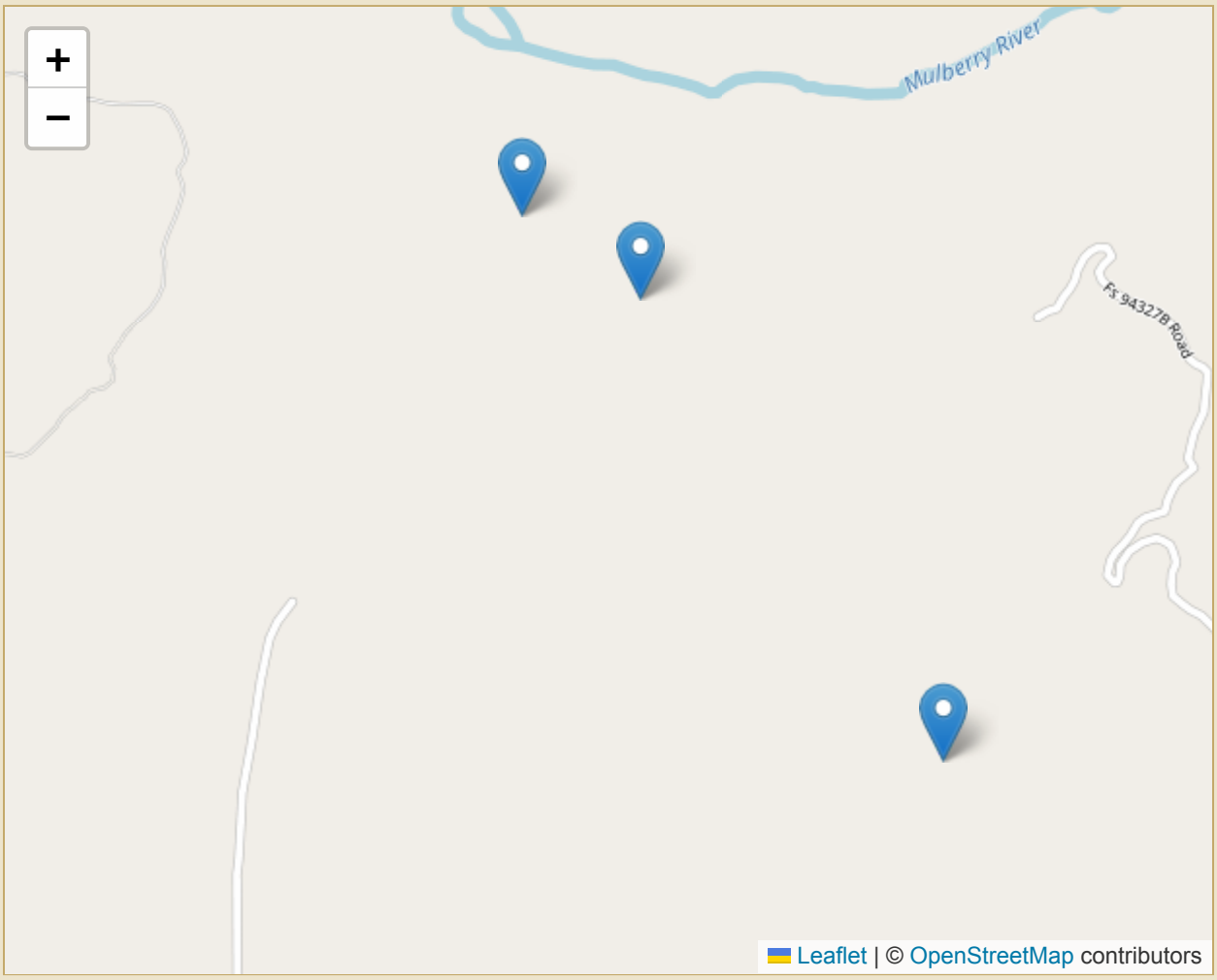
Seven deaths in 163 days. None of them in combat. The first murder came five months before Spencer — when William Gordon Acord was lured out of hiding by an unnamed neighbor who informed bushwhackers of his return from a grist mill. His wife Martha watched from an attic

> window. Their five-year-old son William Columbus witnessed it. The pattern was established before August ever arrived.

§ 04

Site Locations

GPS coordinates recorded by Jimmie Dewberry, 2003. Preserved in FamilySearch record LH23-VP3. All sites are north of Highway 86 (Low Gap Road), approximately 2.3 miles west of Ozone, Arkansas.



Floyd Township, Johnson County, Arkansas — GPS-verified sites — Jimmie Dewberry (2003) — FamilySearch LH23-VP3

LOCATION	GPS COORDINATES	NOTES
Moore Cemetery	Lat. 35°, Long. 093°W, 29.73 min.	Spencer, William, Permelia Horner buried here
Spencer Horner House Site	Lat. 35°, 40.09 min.; Long. 093°W, 29.89 min.	Attack site; potato patch; Spencer's murder
The Bluff / Cave	Lat. 35°, 39.5 min.; Long. 093°W, 29.33 min.	William's hiding place; died here Aug. 10, 1864

Directions: From Ozone, AR, take Highway 86 (Low Gap Road) west approximately 2.3 miles. Turn north toward Farris Springs. A locked cable blocks access approximately one mile from the cemetery.

§ 05

The Principal People

VICTIM · PATRIARCH

John Spencer Horner

b. ~1808, Dickson, TN · d. August 2, 1864

Union-aligned. Shot near the home. According to the 1942 family transcript, he recognized his killers as neighbors. Listed as Sergeant, Co. I, 10th Arkansas Militia (CSA) before switching allegiance. Held Land Patent 19B in Floyd Township since 1857, acquired under Choctaw scrip authority as assignee of Co-cha-tubbee.

VICTIM

William Riley Horner

b. August 1, 1834 · d. August 10, 1864

Son of Spencer. Beaten with pistols in the potato field. Hidden in a cave. Died eight days after the attack from head wounds. Age 30. Served in Co. K, 2nd Arkansas Infantry (US). Muster roll: "reported killed by guerillas 10 August, 1864, Johnson Co., Arkansas."

VICTIM · MARCH 18, 1864

WITNESS · AGE 7

William Gordon Acord

d. March 18, 1864 · Little Mulberry Creek

Ambushed and killed in his own yard after being betrayed by an unnamed neighbor. His wife Martha watched from an attic window. Their son William Columbus, age 5, witnessed the murder. Served in both Co. H, 10th Arkansas Militia (CSA) and Co. K, 2nd Arkansas Infantry (US).

John Samuel Acord

b. December 1, 1856 · d. March 20, 1928 Friley, Johnson County, AR

Orphaned grandson in the house on August 2. Present when his grandfather was shot, per the 1942 family transcript. Later married Amanda Catherine Hill (b. Aug 5, 1859, Yale, AR; d. Apr 19, 1937) — niece of the sheriff who never investigated. 2nd great-grandfather of this archive's compiler.

WITNESS · AGE 3

Christopher Columbus Acord

b. ~1861

Younger brother of John Samuel. Also in the house on August 2. Both boys orphaned before the attack: mother died March 1, father July 28, 1864.

SURVIVOR

Permelia Turner Horner

b. November 11, 1810, Maury Co., TN · d. August 9, 1892

Spencer's wife. Present during the attack. Filed a widow's pension August 17, 1865. Sold the farm for a horse and wagon. Returned to Johnson County after the war. Died one day before the 28th anniversary of William's death in the cave.

SHERIFF / CSA COLONEL

John Fry Hill

b. Aug 9, 1822, Perry, TN · d. Feb 3, 1882, Clarksville, AR

Son of Marcus Mark Hill. Commanded 7th

UNION SOLDIER · BROTHER OF THE SHERIFF

Joseph Hill

b. January 9, 1823, Perry, TN · d. September 1864, Johnson Co., AR

Son of Marcus Mark Hill. Fought for the Union — 2nd Arkansas Cavalry (US). Died one month after Spencer was murdered. His daughter Amanda Catherine Hill later married John Samuel Acord.

Arkansas Cavalry. His regiment was in Dardanelle — directly across the river — on August 3, 1864, the day after the attack. CMSR: "Absent — Detached," September 1864. Wounded at Pilot Knob, September 27, 1864. Filed amnesty petition 1866. Re-elected sheriff 1878. Arkansas Senate 1880.

HILL FAMILY PATRIARCH

Marcus Mark Hill

b. 1790, NC · d. 1878, Mulberry Tsp, Johnson Co., AR

*War of 1812 veteran. Served at the **Battle of New Orleans** under Cpt. Wm. Gault, Co. of Inf., 2nd Reg. W. TN Militia. Early pioneer of Johnson County. Married Rachael Fry, January 1813, Rutherford, Tennessee. Buried at Yale Cemetery, Oark.*

DAUGHTER · WIDOW

Mary Ann Boen Horner

b. 1838 · d. 1912

Daughter of Spencer. Married William Riley Horner. Nursed William in the cave for eight days. Fled to Newton County in 1865.

AWOL · SON-IN-LAW OF SPENCER

Hiram Boen

AWOL May 28, 1864 – January 1, 1865

Son-in-law of Spencer Horner. Co. E, 2nd Arkansas Infantry (US). AWOL the entire period of the summer murders. Desertion charge cleared by War Department 1866, Special Order Bo-276-66, without stated reason.

DAUGHTER · MOTHER OF THE WITNESSES

Elizabeth Horner Acord

b. July 10, 1835, Perry Co., TN · d. March 1, 1864

Spencer's daughter. Died of pneumonia at 28 while her husband was at war. Born in the same county where her grandfather George Horner died in 1822. Mother of John Samuel and Christopher Columbus Acord.

§ 06

The Sheriff Who Did Not Investigate

John Fry Hill was sheriff of Johnson County in August 1864. He had held the office since 1858, and he would hold it until the end of the war. He was also, at that very moment, a colonel in the Confederate army, commanding the 7th Arkansas Cavalry — a regiment raised and operating in the same county where Spencer Horner was murdered.

The 7th Arkansas Cavalry was organized July 25, 1863, built around Hill's own cavalry battalion. Five of its twelve companies were drawn entirely from Johnson County. These were Hill's neighbors — the same men who knew every road, every hollow, and every Unionist family in Floyd Township.

Military records place Hill's regiment in **Dardanelle on August 3, 1864** — directly across the river from Johnson County, the day after the attack. His September 1864 CMSR notation reads **"Absent — Detached"** — consistent with performing civil duties locally as sheriff. He was wounded at the Battle of Pilot Knob, Missouri, on September 27, 1864 — seven weeks after the murders — confirming he was fully active during the critical window.

In his 1866 amnesty petition to President Andrew Johnson, Hill claimed he did not return to Johnson County until October 1865. His military records contradict this directly. The contemporaneous record is the stronger evidence.

The men who killed Spencer Horner were Confederate-aligned irregulars fighting for the same cause Hill commanded troops to support. The sheriff was not going to investigate his own side. There is no record that he ever tried.

> **The bloodline connection:** John Fry Hill's brother Joseph had a daughter named Amanda Catherine Hill, born August 5, 1859, at Yale, Johnson County. She would marry John Samuel Acord — the seven-year-old boy who watched his grandfather get shot in the potato patch. The sheriff who did nothing was the great-uncle of the child who needed justice. The same bloodline, divided by war and duty and the choices men made.

§ 07

The Reckoning

Dr. John Turner Horner was Spencer's son, a thirty-four-year-old physician who had served in the Union army and survived the war. He had watched his family die — his father murdered, his brother beaten to death, his sister dead before the attack, her orphans now his responsibility. He led a squad of men back into the hills.

The names survive in family memory: **Wash Middleton**, **Fate Arnold**, **Jess Wilson**. The family called them desperate men — men willing to do what the law would not.

> *"One night they surrounded a house where the bushwhackers were having a dance. Wash Middleton took the man who killed grandfather by the hair and dragged him out, 'Now you'll kill a helpless old man' and killed him."*
>
> — 1942 Horner family oral history transcript

They killed seventeen of the twenty bushwhackers. A cornfield ambush where each man picked his target. A dance house surrounded at night. Dr. Horner threw his pistol at the leader when it wouldn't fire. A man was shot down between his wife and mother.

The Hunt — An Analysis

According to family oral tradition and the 1942 Horner family transcript, the reprisal was a systematic hunt — not a spontaneous act of grief, but a persistent, organized campaign to track down each of the twenty men responsible for the attack.

Command structure. The squad appears to have been led by men with Union military experience. Dr. Horner had recruited for Company K of the 2nd Arkansas Infantry (US), though the War Department later ruled he never formally enlisted himself. Wash Middleton was the elected 1st Lieutenant of Company E — elected by his fellow soldiers on Christmas Day 1863. The squad

operated with a degree of military discipline and collective purpose common among Union-aligned men who had fought together and knew the terrain and the people on it.

Targeted extraction. The hunt was not indiscriminate. The squad targeted specific individuals known to have been at the potato field. Oral tradition describes targeted killings rather than sweeps — men pulled from hiding places and named for what they had done before being shot. The details of individual targets are given below.

The 17 of 20 claim. The 1942 transcript explicitly states the squad killed seventeen of the twenty bushwhackers. This high body count implies a prolonged campaign that likely extended into the immediate post-war years as the family returned from Missouri. No military tribunal, provost marshal record, or court docket has been found to confirm or deny it. The official record is silent — which is itself a form of evidence about what the community chose not to see.

The context of social war. The hunt took place within what historians call the "social war" of the Ozarks — a state of irregular violence where military, political, and personal grievances intersected and the formal legal system had collapsed. With no recourse through official channels (see § 06), the squad's actions were shielded by community silence — the same silence that had protected the bushwhackers themselves.

The inscription on William Riley's tombstone — *"by parties known to his family"* — was the public record they were left to make: a permanent marker that the family had identified the killers, even if the law had not.

Dr. John Turner Horner

Spencer's son. Physician. Led the reprisal. Recruited for Co. K, 2nd Arkansas Infantry (US), but the War Department ruled in 1894 that he enrolled men without formally enlisting himself — leaving no muster

George Washington "Wash" Middleton

Elected 1st Lieutenant, Co. E, 2nd Arkansas Infantry (US), on Christmas Day 1863. Personally killed the man who murdered Spencer — dragged him from the dance house by the hair, named what he had done, then killed him.

Fate Arnold

Named in family tradition as a squad member. Described as a man who "didn't know what fear was." Located after the war in Stone County, Arkansas. The 1942 transcript describes him as a "little wizened old man" when John Turner Horner's son finally met him.

roll record and no confirmed rank.

James Mitchell "Jess" Wilson

Named in oral history as both a reprisal target and a participant in the original attack. Documented as a Private in the 2nd Arkansas Cavalry (CSA) — listed as a paroled prisoner July 2, 1864, one month before the Horner attack. Oral tradition says he was found hiding under the skirts of his womenfolk before being pulled out and shot.

§ 08

The Named Suspect

The family tradition points to one man by name: **Henry Stewart of Yale, Arkansas**. Born December 1840 — making him twenty-three or twenty-four when Spencer Horner was killed. He lived a long life, dying in 1930, sixty-six years after the murder.

He is buried at Yale Cemetery — the same ground where John "Old Jack" Acord lies. The grandfather of the two boys who watched Spencer die is in the same cemetery as the man the family believed killed him.

> *"It is generally believed that one of the Stewarts from Yale participated in these killings, probably Henry Stewart."*
>
> — FamilySearch contributor HeatherAcord, 2013

Arkansas Ex-Confederate Pension Record — Henry Stewart, 1910–1915, page 283 of 302

Arkansas Ex-Confederate Pension Records, 1891–1939 · Henry Stewart · Pension Lists 1910–1915 · Page 283 of 302 · Ancestry.com / FamilySearch

> **Two men named Henry Stewart.** Official Union rosters list a Henry C. Stewart in the 2nd Arkansas Cavalry (US) — but he was born in Pike County, Missouri, and enlisted in Newton County, Arkansas. Research concludes this is almost certainly a different individual from the Yale Cemetery Henry Stewart. The Yale Stewart received a Confederate pension (1910–1915), which strongly implies Confederate service but is not equivalent to a confirmed military service record — his actual wartime unit and enlistment remain formally undocumented. Family tradition names him as a participant in the killings. No primary document has been found placing him at the Horner homestead on August 2, 1864.

§ 09

The Gold That Stayed Hidden

Spencer Horner had money. Gold and silver and paper, saved over years, hidden somewhere on the farm. The bushwhackers knew it — or believed it. After Spencer was shot and William was left for dead in the potato field, they turned the homestead inside out. They pulled down buildings, knocked fences flat, dug where they thought it might be buried. They never found it. The family never found it either.

Years later, one of Spencer's sons dreamed about it: a black gum tree in the middle of a field, a certain number of steps toward the house, digging down and finding the pot of gold. But dreams are not maps, and the money stayed lost.

Permelia sold the farm for a horse and wagon and left the place where she had raised her children and buried her husband. She came back to Johnson County after the war and lived until 1892, dying on

August ninth — one day before the twenty-eighth anniversary of her son William's slow death in a cave.

§ 10

Documentary Record

MOORE CEMETERY
Photo pending

Moore Cemetery — Spencer, William, and Permelia Horner burial site

WILLIAM RILEY HORNER
TOMBSTONE
Photo pending

"Killed Aug. 10, 1864 by parties known to his family"

CAVE / BLUFF SITE
Photo pending

The overhang where William hid for eight days before dying

LAND PATENT 19B
Choctaw Scrip · April 1, 1857

Choctaw scrip patent — Spencer Horner, assignee of Co-cha-tubbee · Fayetteville Land Office

§ 11

The Line — From the Murder to the Researcher

This archive exists because of an unbroken chain of survival. Seven people, six generations, 162 years — from a potato patch in Floyd Township to a desk in Clarksville, Arkansas.

MURDERED · AUGUST 2, 1864

John Spencer Horner

~1808 – 1864 · Floyd Township, Johnson County, Arkansas

Shot in his potato patch. The subject of this archive.

SPENCER'S DAUGHTER · DIED MARCH 1, 1864

Elizabeth Horner Acord

July 10, 1835 – March 1, 1864 · Perry County, TN → Floyd Township, AR

Died of pneumonia at 28, chopping wood in the cold rain. Her two sons were left as orphans at the farm when Spencer was murdered.

ELIZABETH'S SON · AGE 7 ON THE DAY OF THE MURDER

John Samuel Acord

December 1, 1856 – March 20, 1928 · Friley, Johnson County, Arkansas

Watched his grandfather shot in the potato patch. Later married Amanda Catherine Hill — daughter of Joseph Hill, niece of the sheriff who never investigated. Lived his entire life in Johnson County.

JOHN SAMUEL'S DAUGHTER

Rosie Acord Sexton

July 8, 1898 – September 2, 1983 · Johnson County, Arkansas

Born and died in Johnson County. Her death in 1983 is within living memory.

ROSIE'S DAUGHTER

Argie Faye Sexton Williams

January 6, 1928 – August 29, 2004 · Johnson County, Arkansas

Daughter of Rosie Acord and William Corbit Sexton Sr. Mother of Patricia Lynn Williams. Buried Oakland Memorial Cemetery, Clarksville, Johnson County.

ARGIE'S DAUGHTER · DANIEL'S MOTHER

Patricia Lynn Williams Lingar

December 28, 1956 – December 3, 2021 · Clarksville, Johnson County, Arkansas

Buried West Mount Zion Cemetery, Hartman, Johnson County. Her death in 2021 — in the same county where Spencer Horner was murdered in 1864 — closes the circle.

PATRICIA'S SON · COMPILER OF THIS ARCHIVE

Daniel Bret Lingar

September 12, 1982 · Clarksville, Johnson County, Arkansas

2nd great-grandson of John Samuel Acord. 5th great-grandson of John Spencer Horner. This archive exists because I

> *[illegible] write it down.*

> **The double bloodline.** Daniel Lingar descends from both the Horner victims and the Hill family. John Samuel Acord married Amanda Catherine Hill, daughter of Joseph Hill — the Union soldier whose brother John Fry Hill was the Confederate sheriff who never investigated the murder. The boy who watched his grandfather die married into the family of the man who let the killers go free. Both bloodlines run in the same veins today.

The Killing of John Spencer Horner — Johnson County Civil War Archive

Research by Daniel Lingar · Clarksville, Arkansas

Floyd Township, Johnson County, Arkansas · August 2, 1864

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